

1951, July 26

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed carbon by the
Servant of God, Father Sclenus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

God Bless you Mother Mary Hilda this happy feast day of most privileged
Grand-Mother dear St. Ann. I have started to write you several times
these last more than six months, and whatever the trouble, I can hardly
excuse myself for such negligence in failing to express my appreciation
for your kind remembrances and to say thank you, as I want to do now at
least, with a thousand times God bless you.

I do hope that you keep up in health and courage, persevering in
keeping the Faith and helping Jesus our Savior in the saving of poor
sinner's souls - including our own of course, charity beginning at home.
God help us! How little we appreciate our privilege of being given
opportunity after opportunity of suffering in diverse ways and of offer-
ing all in union with and for the intentions of the Sacred Heart of
Jesus! I have been reading: "The Way of Divine Love; or The Message of
the Sacred Heart to the World", as jotted down and noted by a most privi-
leged contemporary of our own, the little, kitchen-lay-sister Josefa
Menendeth, born in 1890 and called to Heaven December 29, 1923. - all in
strict though gentlest obedience to Jesus and her superiors. What
sufferings of soul and body she went through - what agonies she learned
to welcome! - for the sake of helping Jesus to rescue straying souls!
Glory be to God! Would that we might be convinced - that we might real-
ize - in the time of temptation, of trial and struggle, and when the
clouds seem most threatening that just then it is that Our Dear Lord in
nearest and that just then too we ought to offer all to Jesus - turning
to Him with the holy fear at once and the confidence of the Apostles :"
Lord we perish! - Save us! "

As still a child at home struggling to support her poor parents,
whose modest means had become exhausted through failing health and un-
foreseen family expenses, including the early death of her father, Josepha
had learned many a practical lesson in patience, resignation, confidence
in God; - humility permeating all, supporting every step toward the heights
of Calvary and confidence in Heaven.